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Courtesy: Dubai Media Office

MOHAMMAD WITNESSES AGREEMENT ON SPACE EXPLORATION

■ His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, witnessed the signing of a MoU between MBRSC and Thales Alenia Space. The agreement is to develop a Pressure Equalisation Unit for the Gateway lunar space station which will usher in a new era of human space exploration, paving the way for the first Emirati astronaut to enter the Moon's orbit.

SEE ALSO P5

Dubai set to open world's tallest well-being resort

DH2B THERME DUBAI WILL BE LOCATED IN ZABEEL PARK

DUBAI

BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Shaikh Hamdan Bin Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council, announced plans to open Therme Dubai — the 'world's tallest well-being resort.'

The resort will be located in Zabeel Park and is set to open in 2028. The city has allotted Dh2 billion towards the development, featuring an interactive park and the world's largest indoor botanical garden, designed to host 1.7 million visitors annually.

The project will feature



■ Therme Dubai is scheduled to open in 2028.

three key components — Rest, Relax, and Play. Spanning 500,000 square meters, the 100-meter-tall vertical resort will be the first immersive well-being destination of its kind, according to the Dubai Media Office.

Calling it an iconic addition to Dubai's skyline, Shaikh

Hamdan shared the announcement on his X account.

Enriching experiences

"This innovative project reflects our commitment to enhancing urban biodiversity and environmental sustainability and creating enriching experiences for Dubai's residents and visitors," he said.

Therme Dubai will have a wide array of amenities including natural therapeutic zones, diverse thermal pools, and multiple floors dedicated to well-being and relaxation.

Key attractions include a Michelin-star restaurant, three 18-metre waterfalls, and 4,500-square-metre indoor and terrace pools offering all-year water environments. The project will also feature a play area with 15 waterslides and experiential art installations.



SPORT

**Sam Curran
deserves
a spot in
England
team: Foster**

Desert Vipers' coach targets
ILT20 title | P12

UAE's Paper Bag Boy makes headlines again

Abdul Muqet goes digital for green future

DUBAI

BY SHARMILA DHAL
UAE Editor

Way back in 2010, an eight-year-old boy, Abdul Muqet, became the talk of the town after *Gulf News* carried a story on his initiative to make recycled bags from old newspapers and distribute them to households.

Ever since, he came to be called the Paper Bag Boy. Over the years, he earned many successes to his credit, including the

honour of receiving the Abu Dhabi Award and being chosen as a Unicef Climate Change Youth Advocate.

On UAE Environment Day yesterday, Muqet took to the digital world with a new initiative to urge the community to go green.

As the UAE marks the Year of the Community, he called for collective action to make a lasting environmental impact.



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MIDDLE EAST

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leave, Gazans
say over
Trump's plan for
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leave as fresh
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Greece's
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ENTERTAINMENT

**Screen icon
Audrey
Hepburn's Swiss
retreat lists for
\$21 million | P15**

Pakistan to prioritise skilled workforce for UAE jobs: Ambassador

Two more airlines to start operations between UAE and Pakistan soon

DUBAI

BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Senior Assistant Editor

Pakistanis seeking jobs in the UAE need to get high-end skills as the era of unskilled workers is behind us, said a top envoy.

"Today's world is driven by IT skills, accounting, and health care. We now need to train accountants, IT professionals, bankers, AI experts, physicians, nurses and pilots for the UAE job market," Pakistan's Ambassador to the UAE Faisal Niaz Tirmizi told *Gulf News* in an exclusive interview. He also talked about changing job market needs, new agreements and the massive increase in remittances from UAE to Pakistan.

"With the UAE's demand for skilled workers continuing to grow, the opportunity for Pakistan is immense if they focus on improving skills," he noted.

Key partner

The UAE, he added, has always been a key trading partner of Pakistan in the Mena region, and now the focus is on attracting more investments from the Emirates into Pakistan. "The partnership is not just about sending our workforce abroad



■ Faisal Niaz Tirmizi

but ensuring that Pakistan's economic potential was realised on the global stage. We are talking about a partnership that spans generations," he added.

Ambassador Tirmizi said that remittances from the UAE to Pakistan are already on the rise — up by 53 per cent in just six months, reaching \$4.5 billion. "Our goal is clear: to cross the \$9 billion 'magic' mark in remittances within this fiscal year (ending in June)," he added.

He also revealed that two more airlines would soon start flight operations between UAE and Pakistan. He said that Pakistan and the UAE have reached an agreement to expand flight services between the two nations.

"As part of this agreement, Pakistan's AirSial will begin flights from three Pakistani cities to Abu Dhabi, while Wizz Air will operate flights between Abu Dhabi and two cities in Pakistan," Ambassador Tirmizi explained.

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